

Instructor Information	Office Hours
Name: Adam Emfield	When: Tuesdays 5:30 - 6:30pm or by appointment
E-mail: ageics@rit.edu	Where: https://rit.zoom.us/j/95507787287
Phone: () 339-927-4601	Contact Policy: Students are welcome to make an appointment to meet or login to Zoom during office hours
Course Modality: Online asynchronous	

Course Description

Designing meaningful relationships among people and the products they use is both an art and a science. This course will focus on the unique design practice of

(1) Information architecture: representing and organizing information in such a way as to facilitate perception and understanding and

(2) Interaction design: specifying the appropriate mechanisms for accessing and manipulating task information.

This course will also explore various design patterns (design solutions to particular problems) that are appropriate for the HCI professional. **Students need prior knowledge of an interface prototyping tool.**

Objectives – Skills

- Identify complementary skills and congruent domains among potential project group partners.
- Conduct iterative design, including stages of design, prototyping, and evaluation.
- Conduct a contextual inquiry.
- Construct personas suggested by a contextual inquiry.
- Construct a low-fidelity prototype using pencil and paper.
- Construct a high-fidelity prototype using tools of your own choosing.
- Evaluate a high-fidelity prototype using heuristic evaluation or methods of your own choosing.
- Sketch designs quickly and with facility.
- Solve generic design problems quickly in an ad-hoc group, mastering both the divergent and convergent activities required.
- Tell the story of a design problem and solution through a series of sketches.
- Contribute to a project group over the course of a semester and overcome project group problems.
- Create a project group website that communicates the substance of your semester-long project.

Objectives – Concepts

- Understand the role of constraints in design.
- Understand affordances.
- Understand the history of and basic definitions common in interaction design.
- Understand theories in human computer interaction such as Fitts's Law and Hick's Law and the characteristics of theories.
- Understand interaction paradigms.
- Understand four common interaction styles and the characteristics favoring their use.
- Understand two different ways to elicit and interpret verbal information from users of a system, protocol analysis and verbal analysis

- Understand the role of collaboration among users in interaction design.
- Understand several ways to measure quality of service.
- Understand the role of emotion in interaction design.
- Understand relevant characteristics of a range of interaction devices.
- Understand software documentation and the phenomena taking its place.

Required Text(s) and Materials

The following required textbooks are available online or in MyCourses. There is no other required textbook for this course.

- The UX Book by Hartson and Pyla, published by Morgan Kaufmann (available online through RIT)
- The Interaction Design by Sharp, Rogers, & Preece (5th Edition), used in HCIN610
- Rapid Contextual Design by Holzblatt, Wendall, & Wood (2005)

Additional readings will be recommended but not required.

Notebook. Students will maintain a 5×8.25-inch notebook for sketches and exercises (required). Ideally, you should have a paper notebook for this class and upload pictures from it. Digital notebooks are also accepted, but sketches must be drawn using a stylus. It is helpful to the instructor and your classmates for you to adhere to the size guidelines. This makes it easier to review each other's pages without too much zooming in and out.

Technology. Specific software packages will not be taught in this course. Students are expected to use tools such as Figma, Adobe XD, or Balsamiq for prototyping and wireframing. Collaboration tools like Miro or Lucidchart may also be helpful.

Attendance and Class Participation Policy

The course is online. However, even though there are no required classes to attend you are expected to proactively engage with the content and assignments. Make sure to also join Slack (see the announcement in class). Participating in discussions, answering questions, reading assigned texts, and especially participating in project activities are all good ways to show "active participation".

Statement on Academic Adjustment

RIT is committed to providing academic adjustments to students with disabilities. If you would like to request academic adjustments such as testing modifications due to a disability, please contact the Disability Services Office. Contact information for the DSO and information about how to request adjustments can be found at www.rit.edu/dso. After you receive academic adjustment approval, it is imperative that you contact me as early as possible so that we can work out whatever arrangement is necessary.

Students with other Concerns

Students with academic concerns beyond those related to this course may wish to contact the Academic Advisement team for the School of Information – RIT iSchool.
<https://www.rit.edu/computing/school-of-information>

Students with personal concerns beyond academic issues related to the course may also wish to contact the RIT Counseling Center. <http://www.rit.edu/studentaffairs/counseling/>

Policy on Reporting Incidents of Discrimination and Harassment

RIT is committed to providing a safe learning environment, free of harassment and discrimination as articulated in our university policies located on our governance website. RIT's policies **require faculty to share information** about incidents of gender based discrimination and harassment with RIT's Title IX coordinator or deputy coordinators, regardless whether the incidents are stated to them in person or shared by students as part of their coursework.

RIT Governance website: <https://www.rit.edu/academicaffairs/policiesmanual/policies/governance>

If you have a concern related to gender-based discrimination and/or harassment and prefer to have a **confidential** discussion, assistance is available from one of RIT's confidential resources on campus:

1. The Center for Women & Gender: Campus Center Room 1760; 585-475-7464; CARES (available 24 hours/7 days a week) Call or text 585-295-3533.
2. RIT Student Health Center – August Health Center/1st floor; 585-475-2255.
3. RIT Counseling Center - August Health Center /2nd floor - 2100; 585-475-2261.
4. The Ombuds Office – Student Auxiliary Union/Room 1110; 585-475-7200 or 585-475-7357 or 585-286-4677.
5. The Center for Religious Life – Schmitt Interfaith Center; 585-475-2137 (Assistant Directory Monica Sanford).
6. NTID Counseling & Academic Advising Services – Vicki Liggera valnca@rit.edu or 585-286-3845 (videophone).

Assignments & Discussions

Submission Deadline

Unless otherwise noted, all assignments and discussion questions are due by **11:59 pm Rochester, NY, time** on the due date listed in the course outline below. Due date changes may be announced during lecture or via the HCIN-620 Slack Workspace in the #general channel.

Examinations

There will be a final exam during the final exam week (date and time to be determined).

Late Policy

Work submitted beyond the due date will not be accepted (0% grade) unless prior arrangements have been made with the instructor **prior to the due-date**, and the instructor will consider such requests on a case-by-case basis (and only under extraordinary circumstances would extensions be granted). Extensions to the due date will not be given for technical problems such as broken/unsaved files and computer failures. You are responsible for keeping backup copies of your files. If you are having difficulties completing the assignment, it is imperative that you see me before the due date.

Even if you do not fully complete an assignment, you may submit what you have done to receive partial credit. Requests for extensions after the deadline for an assignment will not be considered. Assignments submitted more than 1 minute late are considered late. If the instructor gives prior approval for an assignment to be submitted late, then a lateness penalty will be applied to the grade. Details of this lateness penalty should be discussed with the instructor prior to the original deadline of the assignment.

In extenuating circumstances, at the instructor's discretion, students may be given an Incomplete if material has not been completed by the end of the semester. When an incomplete is granted, the student and instructor will specify, in writing, a timeframe for all outstanding material to be submitted. If no other timeframe has been specified in writing, the deadline for all outstanding material to be submitted to resolve an incomplete will be one month following the last meeting of the class. An incomplete that is not resolved by the deadline will become an F.

Grading

Project Milestones	40%
Individual Exercises	40%
Participation (discussion, myCourses)	5%
Final Exam	15%
Total	100%

Scale for Final Letter Grade:

- A (93.34%-100%)
- A- (90%-93.33%)
- B+ (87%-89.99%)
- B (83%-86.99%)
- B- (80%-82.99%)
- C+ (77 %-79.99%)
- C (73%-76.99%)
- C- (70%-72.99%)
- D (60%-69.99%)
- F (below 60%)

Grading Questions Policy

Your grades will be posted on myCourses during the semester. If you have specific questions about your grade on an assignment, then the best way to proceed is to send an email with your question to the instructor. You should mention which problem/question you are referring to, and you should discuss why you feel the grade should be reexamined. Grading disputes will only be accepted for one week that starts when the exam or assignment grade was first available to the student.

Writing Skills

Students must demonstrate proficiency in use of the English language. Bachelor-level organization, spelling, grammar, and clear expression of ideas presented are expected in all assignments submitted. The professor will not provide remedial assistance in these areas. Students needing help in basic writing skills may contact the Academic Support Center Reading and Writing Lab, at <http://www.rit.edu/studentaffairs/asc/>

Form and style of writing are of particular importance in business and scholarly writing. The following resources may be useful throughout your graduate work as your writing abilities progress to graduate-level writing:

- On Writing Well, Zinsser, W., (25th anniversary edition).
- Bugs in Writing, Dupre, L., (Second edition).

Academic Integrity Policy

RIT expects students to behave honestly and ethically at all times, especially when submitting work for evaluation in conjunction with any course or degree requirement. The School of Information encourages all students to become familiar with the RIT Honor Code (<https://www.rit.edu/academicaffairs/policiesmanual/p030>) and RIT's Academic Integrity Policy (<https://www.rit.edu/academicaffairs/policiesmanual/d080>). The instructor will also adhere to the School of Information Policy on Academic Dishonesty (which appears on the next page).

Cheating, plagiarism and collusion will not be tolerated, refer to useful guides provided at the Wallace Library Avoid Plagiarism: Cite Right site at <http://infoguides.rit.edu/citationguide> The ACM citation format is **required** in all writing throughout the course. (Other courses might require APA citation format.)

Students who cheat on assignments or who plagiarize material (submitting someone else's work, failing to properly cite sources, or copy/paste information from the Internet) will be reported to the Information Sciences & Technologies department and the GCCIS dean's office.

Copying programming code or other materials from other students or from online sources – even if superficial changes are made – is also considered cheating. In the case of programming code or other digital artifacts, falsifying whether your code or artifact actually operates correctly is considered a form of cheating.

It is OK to discuss assignments with your classmates, but you should write your assignments alone. It is inappropriate to share your work or solutions to assignments with other students. If you discuss an assignment with a classmate or with someone else (in person or online), you should write the name of the classmate or person on your assignment.

Use of Generative AI tools

HCI, like all fields, is increasingly impacted by Artificial Intelligence (AI) and the development of generative AI tools, such as ChatGPT. It is important that you are aware of these advances and gain some experience in their use. There will be situations and contexts within this course where you will be asked to use AI tools to explore how they can be used. Outside of those explicit instances, you may not use AI tools to generate content (text, video, audio, images) that will end up in any student work (assignments, activities, etc.) that is part of your evaluation in this course. You must be able to show your work from an outline to the final draft that you submit. Please save your initial outline as evidence that you created the work from scratch in case there is any doubt about authorship or plagiarism. If you use generative AI tools for these assignments, your actions would be considered academically dishonest and a violation of the Academic Dishonesty Policy. You may use AI tools for proofreading only (e.g., Grammarly).

ACADEMIC DISHONESTY POLICY

School of Information – RIT iSchool, Golisano College of Computing and Information Sciences

The following statement is the Policy on Academic Dishonesty for the Department of Information Technology:

The Department of Information Technology does not condone any form of academic dishonesty. Any act of improperly representing another person's work as one's own (or allowing someone else to represent your work as their own) is construed as an act of academic dishonesty. These acts include, but are not limited to, plagiarism in any form or use of information and materials not authorized by the instructor during an examination or for any assignment.

If a faculty member judges a student to be guilty of any form of academic dishonesty, the student will receive a **FAILING GRADE FOR THE COURSE**. Academic dishonesty involving the abuse of RIT computing facilities may result in the pursuit of more severe action.

If the student believes the action by the instructor to be incorrect or the penalty too severe, the faculty member will arrange to meet jointly with the student and with the faculty member's immediate supervisor. If the matter cannot be resolved at this level, an appeal may be made to the GCCIS Academic Conduct Committee.

If the faculty member or the faculty member's immediate supervisor feels that the alleged misconduct warrants more severe action than failure in the course, the case may be referred to the GCCIS Academic Conduct Committee. The Academic Conduct Committee can recommend further action to the dean of the student's college including academic suspension or dismissal from the Institute.

The following definitions will be used to clarify and explain unacceptable conduct. This is not intended to be an exhaustive list of specific actions but a reasonable description to guide one's actions.

CHEATING includes knowingly using, buying, stealing, transporting or soliciting in whole or part the contents of an administered/unadministered test, test key, homework solution, paper, project, software project or computer program, or any other assignment. It also includes using, accessing, altering, or gaining entry to information held in a computer account or disk owned by another.

COLLUSION means the unauthorized collaboration with another person in preparing written work or computer work (including electronic media) offered for credit. Final work submitted by a student must be substantially the work of that student. Collaboration on an assignment is expressly forbidden unless it is explicitly designated as a group project. When there is any doubt, a student should consult the instructor (NOT ANOTHER STUDENT) as to whether some action is considered collusion.

Whenever there is any question as to whether a particular action is considered academic dishonesty, the instructor should be consulted.